

Toggling the vCenter Server Appliance default shell

<https://knowledge.broadcom.com/external/article?legacyId=2100508>

Currently, the vCSA is bundled with these supported shells:

- BASH Shell
- Appliance Shell

Switching the vCenter Server Appliance 6.x to BASH Shell

1. Log in to the vCenter Server Appliance through SSH.
2. Run this command to enable access the Bash shell:

```
shell.set --enabled true
```

3. Type shell and press Enter.
4. In the temporary BASH shell, run this command to permanently configure the default Shell to BASH for root:

```
chsh -s /bin/bash root
```

5. Log out from the BASH Shell.
6. Log in again for the changes to take effect.

Note: For 6.7 and higher, please do the below.

1. Log in to the vCenter Server Appliance through SSH.
2. Type shell and press Enter.
3. In the temporary BASH shell, run this command to permanently configure the default Shell to BASH for root:

```
chsh -s /bin/bash root
```

4. Log out from the BASH Shell.
5. Log in again for the changes to take effect.

Switching the vCenter Server Appliance 6.x to Appliance Shell

1. Log in to the vCenter Server Appliance through SSH.

2. Run this command to change from using the BASH Shell to the Appliance Shell:

```
chsh -s /bin/apliancesh root
```

3. Log out from the Appliance Shell.
4. Log in again for the changes to take effect.

https://docs.redhat.com/en/documentation/red_hat_enterprise_linux/6/html/v2v_guide/preparation_before_the_p2v_migration-enable_root_login_over_ssh#Preparation_Before_the_P2V_Migration-Enable_Root_Login_over_SSH

5.2.2. Enable root login over SSH

Now that **virt-v2v** is installed, the conversion server must be prepared to accept P2V client connections. The P2V client connects to the conversion server as root using SSH, so root login over SSH must be allowed on the conversion server.

Enable root login over SSH:

1. As root, edit the `sshd_config` file in `/etc/ssh/sshd_config`:

```
nano /etc/ssh/sshd_config
```

2. Add a line in the Authentication section of the file that says *PermitRootLogin yes*. This line may already exist and be commented out with a "#". In this case, remove the "#".
3. # Authentication:
4. #LoginGraceTime 2m
5. PermitRootLogin yes
6. #StrictModes yes
7. #MaxAuthTries 6

```
#MaxSessions 10
```

8. Save the updated `/etc/ssh/sshd_config` file.
9. Restart the SSH server:

```
service sshd restart
```

You can now connect to the conversion server as root over SSH.